MR. LIFE MANAGER · FREE GUIDE

How Often Should I…?

The cadences nobody tells you, in one place.

DAILY Every day

≈10 minutes

TASK	GOOD ENOUGH	BETTER
Dishes washed or in the dishwasher	Before bed	After each meal
Kitchen counters wiped	Before bed	As you cook
Stovetop wiped	While still warm	After each use
Things put back where they live	Once, before bed	As you go
Make the bed	Most days	Daily
Dryer lint trap ⚠	**Every load**	Every load
Food put away, nothing left out	Before bed	Right after eating

WEEKLY Every week

45–90 minutes

TASK	GOOD ENOUGH	BETTER
Bathroom — toilet, sink, mirror	Weekly	Twice weekly
Shower or tub	Every 1–2 weeks	Weekly
Vacuum main areas	Weekly	Twice weekly, or daily with pets
Mop hard floors	Every 2 weeks	Weekly
Dust surfaces	Every 2 weeks	Weekly
Change sheets	Every 2 weeks	**Weekly**
Clear out the fridge	Before you shop	—
Laundry	Weekly, set day	—
Wipe down the microwave	Weekly	When it splatters
Check bank accounts	Weekly, 5 min	—
Plan the week, look at the calendar	Weekly, 20–30 min	—

BY USE, NOT BY CALENDAR

ITEM	WASH OR REPLACE AFTER
Bath towels	3–4 uses
Hand towels	2–3 days
Kitchen dish towels	2–3 days

ITEM	WASH OR REPLACE AFTER
Kitchen sponge	Replace every 1–2 weeks
Pillowcases	With sheets — more often with acne, eczema, allergies, night sweats, or a pet in the bed
Bras	2–3 wears
Jeans	4–5 wears — genuinely, not a myth
Bath mat	Every 1–2 weeks
Reusable water bottle	**Daily** — the one people skip

MONTHLY Every month

TASK	GOOD ENOUGH	BETTER
Test smoke and CO detectors ⚠	Monthly	Monthly
Dishwasher filter — pull and rinse	Monthly	Every 2 weeks
Washing machine — hot empty cycle	Monthly	Monthly
Garbage disposal	Monthly	Every 2 weeks
Drains — flush with hot water	Monthly	—
Oven interior	Every 3 months	Monthly
Fridge — full wipe-out	Monthly	—
Air filter — check it	Monthly	—
Vacuum under and behind furniture	Monthly	—
Review spending	Monthly	—
Shower head — descale	Every 3 months	Monthly
Wash pillows	Every 3–6 months	Quarterly
Replace toothbrush	Every 3 months	After illness too

SEASONAL Every 3–6 months

TASK	WHEN
Air filter — change it	Every 1–3 months. Sooner with pets. The size is printed on the old one.
Baseboards and door frames	Quarterly
Windows, inside	Quarterly
Light fixtures and ceiling fans	Quarterly

TASK	WHEN
Refrigerator coils — vacuum	Twice a year
Flip or rotate the mattress	Every 6 months — check the manufacturer first
Wash comforter or duvet	Every 3–6 months
Deep clean one room at a time	Rotate quarterly — never all at once
Review subscriptions	Quarterly. Cancel what you forgot about.
Check that your backups actually restore ⚠	Quarterly — the step everyone skips
Dentist	Every 6 months, or as your dentist says

ANNUAL Once a year

TASK	NOTES
Dryer vent duct — clean ⚠	**Fire risk.** Not the lint trap — the duct behind the dryer.
Smoke and CO detector batteries ⚠	Pick a memorable date and keep it
Water heater — flush	Renting? This is your landlord's job — report it.
Gutters	Twice a year, if they're yours
Caulk and grout — inspect	Re-seal before water gets behind it
Check for leaks under every sink	Five minutes; catches expensive problems
Insurance review	Renter's, auto, health — at renewal
Credit report check	Free from the official federal source
Gather tax documents	January
Physical / annual checkup	Or as your provider advises
Eye exam	Every 1–2 years
Wardrobe clear-out	Annually
Review this list against your actual life	Annually

VEHICLE Check your manual first

Intervals vary a lot by vehicle, oil type, and how you drive. Treat these as "go look it up," not as the answer.

TASK	TYPICAL GUIDANCE
Oil change	**Follow your owner's manual.** The old 3,000-mile rule is usually obsolete.
Tire pressure	Monthly, and before long trips. Check when tires are cold.
Tire rotation	Per manual — commonly every other oil change
Registration and inspection	Per your state. **Put the expiration on a calendar.**
Wiper blades	Every 6–12 months, or when they streak
Air filter, brakes, fluids	Per manual; checked at each service

NOW When "as needed" means today

SITUATION	DO IT
A spill	Immediately. Wet is 10 seconds; dried is 3 minutes.
A stain on clothing	Immediately. Set stains are usually permanent.
A slow drip or running toilet	This week. Cheap fix, expensive flood.
A stain appearing on a ceiling ⚠	**Today.** Report it in writing if you rent.
Smoke detector chirping	Today. The battery is dying.
Anything your landlord is responsible for	Report in writing, immediately. The paper trail protects your deposit.

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